BOUTIQUE RESORTS

HIGH HIDEAWAYS

10 MOUNTAIN RETREATS–AND SOME GLAMPING OPTIONS–FOR A MEMORABLE SUMMER BREAK

By Satarupa Paul



We can never get enough of the hills.

The breathtaking vistas are often enough to merit a getaway; but add to that a dash of luxury and some unique experiences, and an unforgettable vacation is in the making. This summer, find solace in the mountains with these hill retreats that marry indulgent stays with soul-enriching experiences and conscious practices.

WESTERN GHATS

Taj Wayanad Resort & Spa, Kerala

There's no dearth of mesmerising landscapes in this nature-forward state down south. Yet, when you arrive at the latest Taj property in Wayanad, you may find yourself awestruck by the sheer beauty of its setting. Set on a 10-acre peninsular hill abutting the Banasura Lake, the resort affords a 270-degree view of the pristine water body and forested hills. Waterfront villas and cottages sport a vernacular design with locally sourced materials such as bamboo and Kannur terracotta. A 25-metre infinity pool invites you to lounge, an array of gastronomic indulgences is on offer, including southern cuisines, while for experience-seekers, there are village visits, cycling tours, masterclasses with local craftsmen and more.

From 18,000; www.tajhotels.com



The Machan, Maharashtra

Inspired by the hunting platforms of yore, this treehouse resort in the forested hills of Lonavala presents all the thrill of being in the wild. A choice of machans is done up invitingly in wood with expansive glass windows lending a feeling of being one with the dense forests. The Machan also has four kilometres of private paths on which guided trails are conducted. Almost all their energy is generated off-grid from renewable sources, parabolic solar cookers are used for a chunk of the cooking, while 80 per cent of all grey water is recycled and reused. Birdwatching, campfires and stargazing, orchids-spotting and leisurely hikes to hidden waterfalls are just a few of the many things to do here.

From Rs 24,980; www.themachan.com

